

HOW TO CARE FOR YOURSELF AFTER MEASLES TESTING

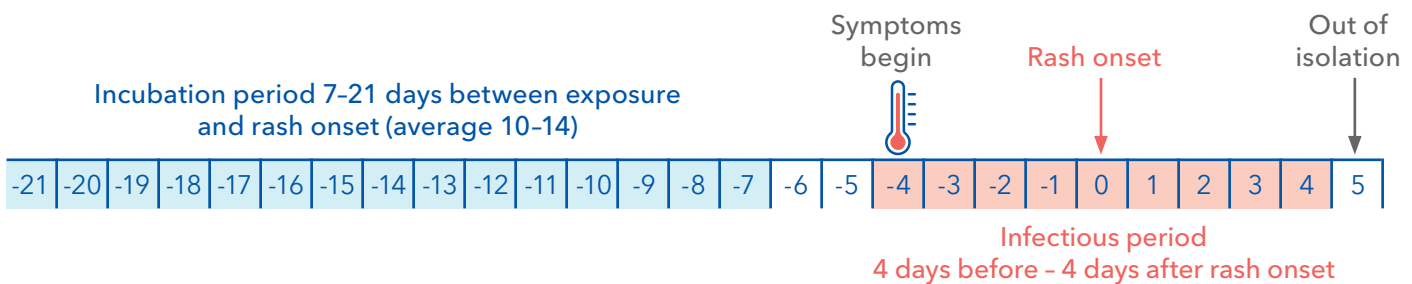
What is measles?

Measles is a very contagious respiratory infection. It often causes:

- Fever
- Rash
- Cough, runny nose, and/or red or irritated eyes

You can spread measles from 4 days before the rash starts to 4 days after it starts.

If you are exposed to measles but are not immune, symptoms often start about 6 to 21 days later (most often at around 2 weeks).



How does measles spread?

Measles spreads **through the air when an infected person coughs or sneezes** (respiratory droplets). It also spreads by touching fluids from an infected person's nose or mouth.

- The virus can stay in the air and on surfaces up to **2 hours**.
- If you are **not immune**, you can get infected just by being in the same room as someone with measles.

What should I do while waiting for test results?

Since measles is very contagious, **take the following precautions until you receive your test results:**

- **Stay home:** Avoid public places, such as work, school, and crowds.
- **Limit contact:** Avoid close contact with others, especially infants, pregnant people, and those with weakened immune systems.
- **Practice good hygiene:** Wash your hands often and cover your mouth when coughing or sneezing.
- **Monitor your symptoms:** Seek medical help if you have trouble breathing or other serious symptoms.

What if I need medical help?

Most people recover from measles. But there are times when you should seek medical help right away.

Seek help if you have any of these:

- Trouble breathing
- Trouble with eating or drinking
- Fever that does not get better
- Confusion
- Extreme drowsiness or difficulty waking up

Call 911 for emergencies. Tell them you (or the person you are calling for) just had a measles test. This lets the emergency team take steps to stay safe.

Call your primary care provider if this is not an emergency. Call your provider's office and let them know you just had a measles test. They may be able to set up a telehealth visit to help guide you about the next best steps.

How Long Will It Take to Get My Test Results?

- It typically takes **1-2 business days**. Measles testing is done at the Kentucky state lab (Monday through Friday).
- Until they are ready, follow the steps under "What should I do while waiting for test results?"

Where can I get more information on measles?

Visit the CDC's website: [cdc.gov/measles](https://www.cdc.gov/measles)

For local questions or concerns, contact:

- Lexington Fayette County Health Department: 859-252-2371
- If you are a University of Kentucky patient, please call the clinic site where you are seen (<https://ukhealthcare.uky.edu/hospitals-clinics>) or 859-257-1000 for assistance